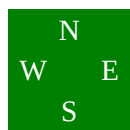


Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 10 9 7 2
♥ A 8
♦ 10 8 3
♣ 10 9 6 4

♠ K 4
♥ K 10 4 3
♦ A 7 5
♣ K Q J 2



♠ A J 6
♥ Q J 9 7 5 2
♦ 6 4 2
♣ 8

♠ Q 8 5 3
♥ 6
♦ K Q J 9
♣ A 7 5 3

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by North			

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 4

There is no reason to hold up. Besides, you have bigger problems to deal with.

After you take the ♦ A at trick one you have four fast losers staring you in the face the instant you lose the lead. So do you pull trumps now?

No, you dare not touch trumps yet - remember those 4 fast losers.

You cannot avoid the ♥ A and ♣ A, so you must get rid of one of the ♦ losers before you play trumps.

Win the ♦ A, play the ♠ K, then finesse the ♠ J. If the finesse works discard a ♦ on the ♠ A, then pull trumps. If the finesse fails you will go down 2 instead of 1.

You made it - on a 50% chance.

When the cards MUST lie in a particular way for the contract to be makeable, just assume that's the way they lie and go for it.

With 10 points and a 6-card ♥ suit you want to transfer. You say 2♦ and partner bids 2♥.

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You know you want to play in ♥s since partner will have at least 2 of them. Your problem is whether to merely invite with 3♥ or go ahead and bid the game. Since partner has either 15, 16 or 17 points you should probably just bid 4♥. The worst thing that could happen is that partner would be playing game with only 25 points.

The contract would be 4♥ played by South.

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♦ K. Do you hold up or not?

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 7 4 3
♥ A Q 7 2
♦ 7 5 3
♣ K 8 4

♠ A 6

♥ 6 3

♦ Q 10 9 8 4

♣ Q J 10 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 10 5

♥ K 5 4

♦ A K 6

♣ A 5 2

♠ K 9 8 2

♥ J 10 9 8

♦ J 2

♣ 9 7 3

West	North	East	South
		1NT	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♠	Pass
2NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by East

♠ Q. If North wins with a doubleton ♠ honor you will only be able to win 1 ♠ since South will sit there with ♠ A 9 or ♠ K 9 behind your ♠ J 10.

Instead, win the first trick in dummy and play a small ♠ toward the ♠ Q J 10. North will play low and South must take his ♠ honor. But you can win his return, enter dummy and play another ♠ toward your hand. If you are lucky, North will be forced to play an honor and you can toss your ♠ 5.

to see if you were lucky.

This plan, leading toward your ♠ holding twice, will succeed the majority of the time.

It only fails if South holds 4 or more ♠s headed by A K.

In response to partner's Stayman bid you show your 4-card ♠ suit. Partner now bids 2NT.

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You may disagree with the Stayman bid on 3-4-3-3 distribution. In any case, 2NT is invitational, so with 17 points you say 3NT.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♥ J.

Winner List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 3/4 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 7/8

South's ♥ J lead probably means ♥s won't be 3-3, so you will need to get 2 ♠ tricks.

Suppose you win the first trick and plunk down the ♠ Q. If North wins with a doubleton ♠ honor you will only be able to win 1 ♠ since South will sit there with ♠ A 9 or ♠ K 9 behind your ♠ J 10.

Board 5

South Deals
None Vul

♠ J 9 2
♥ J 8 5
♦ J 10 4
♣ J 7 5 2

♠ 8 6 5
♥ K 7 2
♦ A Q 9
♣ 10 6 4 3

N
W E
S

♠ K Q 10 3
♥ Q 10 6 3
♦ K 7 5 2
♣ 8

♠ A 7 4
♥ A 9 4
♦ 8 6 3
♣ A K Q 9

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1NT
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			